CISON AT 50: EBUH DECLARES STATISTICS A SINE QUA NON FOR NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

By Imoke Etorti| Abuja | 15 October 2026

Dr Godday U. Ebuh, President of the Chartered Institute of Statisticians of Nigeria (CISON), has declared statistics a sine qua non for national development, calling for a decisive shift from data collection to evidence-driven governance.

Delivering the keynote address at CISON's 3rd International Conference and 50th Anniversary Celebration in Abuja, Dr Ebuh challenged Nigeria to elevate statistics from a supporting administrative function to a strategic instrument of national leadership, accountability and sustainable development.

He called for stronger statistical institutions, adequate funding, professional independence, qualified personnel and timely public access to reliable data.

His proposed reforms include restoring statistics to secondary-school curricula, conducting the long-overdue population and housing census, establishing functional bureaus of statistics in all 36 states, and integrating data science more firmly into statistics education.

He further advocated a coordinated national programme for statistical development, underpinned by sustainable financing, common data standards and measurable performance targets.

Paying tribute to the pioneers who have shaped Nigeria's statistical profession over five decades, Dr Ebuh urged a new generation of statisticians to translate that enduring legacy into tangible national progress.

His message was unmistakable: a nation that neglects credible statistics imperils its development, while one that places evidence at the heart of governance strengthens its capacity to plan wisely, lead effectively and prosper sustainably.

"As CISON marks fifty years of professional heritage, the challenge is clear: Nigeria must move beyond celebrating its statistical past to embracing statistical leadership as an indispensable pathway to its future", Dr. Ebuh asserted